

By **BOB BEEBE**

Minneapolis Star Staff Writer

INDIANAPOLIS, Ind.—The American Association will open its 56th consecutive baseball season here tonight with two charter members—Minneapolis and Indianapolis—meeting at Victory field.

On the mound for Minneapolis will be Stu Miller and the little righthander feels he is ready to "go nine."

"I didn't have quite as good a spring as I would have liked," he said when he arrived Monday from Florida to meet his teammates coming down from the north. "I had some control trouble; was getting behind too much. But

I've been getting the slow curve over better than for a couple of seasons. I worked on it in a seven-inning job down at Sanford Friday and it was hitting the plate nearly all the time.

"**I KNOW** I haven't gone the distance yet, but two years ago I pitched only 10 innings in Florida and none on the way north but went nine and won opening night 3-1. It's different when you're playing for keeps."

Al Corwin, who came from Florida with Miller, will start Wednesday night and Manager Red Davis, looking over a depleted pitching staff, said he planned to start Mike Blyzka and Joe Shipley in Wichita

Thursday and Friday "unless we get something from the New York Giants that would change my mind. I liked the way Shipley threw against Milwaukee and think he should have a chance."

Something undoubtedly will come from the Giants and right away because Bill Rigney must cut two players before the Giants take the field in Pittsburgh today.

Southpaw Vibert Clarke and righthanded Freddy Rodriguez will be in the bullpen tonight and probably will be permanent denizens of that area.

Meanwhile Manager Andy Cohen of Indianapolis still was playing eeny, meeny, miney, mo with his opening pitching choice although he admitted he was leaning toward 20-year-old Barry Latman over 37-year-old Al Papai. "If the weather was warmer I'd pitch 'Pappy' because of his experience," said Andy. "But it isn't going to be too warm."

COHEN also still was waiting for his new shortstop Jose Valdivielso to show up from Washington. Jose will play if he gets here.

THE NEWS that Bob Schmidt would join the Millers in Minneapolis next week, probably ready to catch was welcome news to Davis. Jake Jenkins now carries the full load with only rookie Len Jackson around to help. "Schmidt is a good receiver, a real good receiver," Red declared. "And he swings a pretty good bat."

The players were happy to see Valmy Thomas become a bona fide big leaguer in the transaction, and more than one is saying, "I told you so."

Game time tonight is 6:45 Minneapolis time.

a 'Growing Boy'

stated that he believed a fight with Eddie Machen, ranked No. 2, would be much better a year from now. "I don't think Machen is ready yet," he said.

D'Amato also said that Mederos has instructions to fight his best, so "it'll be a different kind of an exhibition as the people will see."

* * *

Also to be seen on the card are a couple of good club six rounders. Ray Wells, fighting three minute rounds this time, will try to win his first pro fight from Terry Rindal. Rindal won his first time out.

And then heavyweight Wayne Womochil meets

Benny Mason in the main event.

FISTISTICS: Promoter Inigo Lucchesi of Tacoma, Wash., says he'll offer Patterson \$100,000 to meet Irish Pat McMurtry if McMurtry wins in "sensational" fashion from Edgardo Romero Thursday night . . . The Old Guards of the ring will have former welter king Jimmy McLarnin as guest speaker next Monday at the annual dinner at the Calhoun Beach hotel.

An eight-bout amateur card at Hallie Q. Brown tonight features Upper Midwest champions flyweight Jimmy Jackson, welter Jimmy Shaw and light heavyweight Leroy Bogar . . .